The Reversal

Oil $120→$94. S&P flips from –1.5% to +0.88%. Trump says war nearing end. G7 meets today.

MARKETS

THE BIGGEST INTRADAY REVERSAL OF THE WAR. S&P +0.88%, Nasdaq +1.34%, Dow +0.56%, Russell +1.09%. These numbers don't tell the story. At the open, the Nasdaq was down 1.5%. Oil had touched $120 overnight. Futures were down 900 points. Then two things happened: the G7 signaled it would take necessary measures on oil reserves, and Trump told the New York Post he has a plan to bring down prices and said the war is nearing completion. Oil collapsed 30% from peak to trough in a single session—from $120 to $86. UVXY cratered 14.96%.

WTI settled at $94, Brent at $98. Still elevated, but the $120 overshoot was a panic spike, not a sustainable level. The G7 energy ministers meet virtually this morning to discuss a coordinated release of strategic reserves (400M barrels). G7 finance ministers met Monday but stopped short of committing. France's Lescure said they're not there yet but will use any necessary tools. Three G7 members, including the US, support the release.

Friday's jobs report was terrible: 92,000 jobs **shed** in February—the first negative print in years. The labor market is cracking. TLT rallied +0.87% as the bond market prices in a growth scare. 10-year at 4.10%. The Fed is stuck: oil inflation says don't cut, labor weakness says cut. Stagflation is no longer a hypothetical.

Tech led the close: XLK +1.80%. Healthcare +1.02%. Only energy (–0.44%) and financials (–0.47%) finished red. The market is telling you it wants to buy growth if oil comes down. BlackRock said Monday they expect the shock to be short-lived and continue to favor US and Japan equities.

IOWN Tactical: S&P at ~6,796 (SPY $678.27). Down ~10% from January highs. Getting closer to watch levels but still above our –20% buy trigger. CPI on Wednesday and PCE on Friday are this week's macro events—neither will capture the oil spike yet, but expectations matter. G7 reserve decision today is the near-term binary.

IOWN HOLDINGS: THE SESSION

GROWTH HYBRID LED THE REVERSAL. Top 5: MARA +8.11% ($8.66), AMD +5.33% ($202.68), SUPV +4.10% ($8.63), KEYS +3.52% ($282.02), HUT +3.55% ($48.74). The crypto-semi-EM sleeve ripped as the risk-on trade came flooding back in the afternoon. AMD recaptured $200 on the AVGO tailwind and the Broadcom $100B AI forecast.

Semis were the backbone: NVDA +2.72% ($182.65), TSM +2.89% ($348.70), NXPI +1.74% ($205.25), QCOM +1.78% ($138.11). The VanEck Semiconductor ETF gained 0.9% on the day. AI infrastructure demand is immune to the oil shock—this is the clearest signal of the week.

Gold miners rallied: GFI +3.35% ($52.13), AEM +1.70% ($224.75). Gold itself was flat, but the miners are catching a bid on the inflation hedge narrative. FINV +3.48% ($5.35)—Chinese fintech rebounding as China's markets held relatively well during the global rout.

The pain: VLO –3.86% ($215.95)—the biggest loser. Refiners are selling despite $100 oil because the crude/product spread is compressing and demand destruction fears are real. ORI –2.25%, SSNC –1.83%, CNX –1.66%. Energy midstream (OKE –1.12%) also weak. LMT –1.13%—defense selling the news as Trump signals the end.

Note: Several dividend holdings returned no data from Finnhub today (ABT, A, ADI, ATO, ADP, BKH, CAT, CHD, CL, FAST, GD, GPC, LRCX). Will monitor for data restoration.

Benchmarks: DVY –0.26%, IWS +0.51%, IUSG +1.62%. Growth massively outperforming value and income. Our growth hybrid strategy beat IUSG on the day. The rotation is clear: if oil comes down, growth wins.

DIGITAL ASSETS

BTC $70,351 (+3.27% 24h). ETH $2,051 (+2.22% 24h). Bitcoin held $70K through a session where oil hit $120 and the Nikkei crashed 5%. That's the safe-haven thesis in action. IBIT +1.37% ($39.13), ETHA +2.95% ($15.37). COIN +1.30% ($199.79). MARA +8.11%.

Fear & Greed recovered from 8 to 13—still deep Extreme Fear. BTC dominance at 57.0%, total market cap $2.48T. Bitcoin strategists noted crypto's resilience amid the war, with some calling it the cleanest safe-haven trade of the conflict. Our digital asset sleeve is outperforming every other sleeve in the portfolio over the past two weeks.

The narrative is shifting permanently. BTC didn't just survive the oil shock—it rallied through it. Two weeks ago this was a theoretical thesis. Now it's market data. The GENIUS Act, institutional ETF flows, and geopolitical demand are converging.

GEOPOLITICS

DAY 11. TRUMP SAYS WAR NEARING COMPLETION. That single statement drove the afternoon reversal. He told the New York Post he has a plan to curb oil prices and held a 5:30 PM conference. Israel's ambassador to France said they're ahead of schedule on war goals. Defense Secretary Hegseth earlier called this just the beginning—mixed signals, but the market chose to believe the optimistic one.

Iran named Mojtaba Khamenei as new supreme leader (sworn in March 9). Iran struck Bahrain's Bapco oil refinery for the second time in 24 hours—380K bpd facility. Kuwait, UAE, Qatar remain in force majeure. Iraq production down 70%. NATO intercepted a ballistic missile entering Turkish airspace—Patriot systems now deployed in Turkey.

G7 energy ministers meet virtually this morning. The reserve release (400M barrels) would cover less than 4 days of global consumption but would cap oil psychologically at $90–100. Gas prices nationally at $3.48, expected to hit $4/gallon by end of week. American Farm Bureau warned Trump the war threatens agricultural input costs.

ON OUR RADAR

1. G7 energy ministers meeting this morning is the catalyst. If they commit to a coordinated reserve release, oil drops to $85–90 and equities rally hard. If they punt again, oil retests $100+ and yesterday's reversal was a head-fake. This is the single most important event of the day.

2. Monday's reversal was historic. Oil from $120 to $86. Nasdaq from –1.5% to +1.34%. UVXY –15%. This is the kind of capitulation-to-recovery pattern that marks intermediate bottoms. But it needs follow-through today. Watch if the S&P can hold 6,800.

3. The jobs report was awful. 92K jobs shed in February. This changes the Fed calculus. If inflation expectations stay anchored despite oil, the Fed may cut sooner than September. TLT's +0.87% rally is the bond market pricing this in. Growth stocks benefit from rate cuts—another reason semis led Monday.

4. Semis are the new safe haven within equities. AMD +5.33%, NVDA +2.72%, TSM +2.89% on a day the Dow was barely green. AI capex is non-discretionary. The AVGO $100B forecast, GTC next week, and insatiable data center demand create a floor under these names regardless of oil.

5. VLO –3.86% is the contrarian signal. When a refiner sells off during a 10% oil rally, the market is pricing in demand destruction. If oil stabilizes at $85–95 (post-G7 release), VLO becomes a buy. If oil goes to $120 sustained, VLO was right to sell. Watch the spread.

6. CPI Wednesday, PCE Friday, Oracle and Adobe earnings. CPI won't capture the oil spike yet but expectations matter. Oracle and Adobe give us another read on enterprise software demand. GTC is one week away—the semis are trading on anticipation.

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